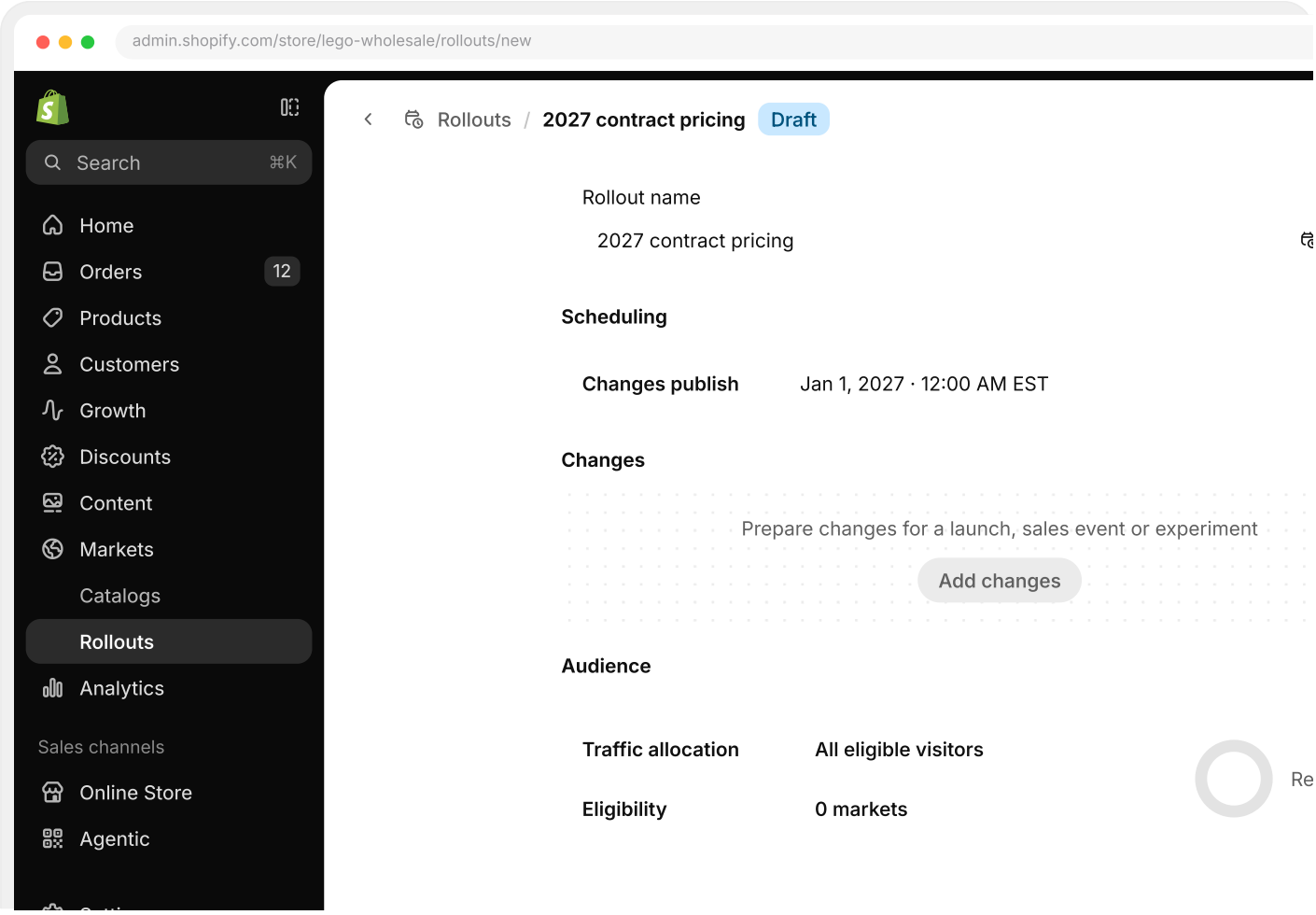
Independent · Independent product strategy investigation · Public-source research · November 2026

Shopify built two ways to price a B2B customer.

I wanted to understand why before proposing a third. A B2B market can target a specific company location and be scheduled through Rollouts. A directly assigned catalog takes precedence over a matching market catalog for overlapping products, but cannot itself be scheduled.



Illustrative recreation of the Shopify admin, not a screenshot of a live account. LEGO appears as a hypothetical merchant (it isn't a Shopify customer); Brickyard Toys and its contract prices are fictional.

Confirmed on 3 Shopify Help Center pages · Admin GraphQL schema 2026-10 read

6 public signals · merchant interviews not yet done · Catalog Rollouts shipped 23 Oct 2026

Independent work. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Shopify. I have no access to Shopify's internal data, I have not interviewed Shopify merchants, and this is not a shipped Shopify product or an internal Shopify project.

The thesis



By Praharsha Nelaturi

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About the author →

Shopify gives Plus merchants two ways to assign a B2B catalog to a company location.

A B2B market can target specific locations and be scheduled through Rollouts.

A directly assigned catalog takes precedence over a matching market catalog for overlapping products, but can't itself be scheduled.

Both deliver location-specific pricing.

I don't yet know when the override is worth its limitation.

Here's how I'd find out.

The difference between the two is how each expresses the customer relationship, how pricing precedence resolves, and whether catalog changes can be scheduled. I want to understand when the higher-priority direct assignment is valuable enough to justify its operational limitation, and whether a single-location market is a practical alternative at scale.

I started out trying to prove that Shopify's premium B2B pricing mechanism had a scheduling gap. It does, but a workaround exists, and finding it late nearly killed this document. What survived is narrower and more useful. Whether the split is deliberate design or an artifact of how the product grew, I can't tell from outside. This is the investigation that would settle it, including the parts where I was wrong.

PM lens

This is a platform-product discovery exercise. I tested an apparent feature gap against documented product behavior, traced targeting, precedence and activation across two configuration models, separated public signals from customer proof, and built a decision-gated validation plan before recommending engineering investment.

The method applies beyond commerce: it is relevant to any product where multiple configuration paths serve a similar customer outcome but behave differently.

Project summary

Product area	B2B commerce and catalog management
Problem type	Configuration and precedence asymmetry
Work completed	Completed Public documentation research, API-schema analysis, product-rule mapping, public-signal analysis, hypotheses and decision plan
Not completed	Proposed next steps Merchant interviews, internal usage analysis, engineering feasibility validation, implementation
Recommendation	**Do not build yet**

The main reading path

Seven stops. Full exhibits, the Q&A and the discovery log sit in the appendix; details open on demand.

1. The product problem and my initial assumption
2. What I discovered that changed the thesis
3. The two catalog models and their precedence
4. What the evidence supports, and what it doesn't
5. The four outcomes and the no-build recommendation
6. The five investigations and their decision gates
7. The conditional concept, risks and success measures

The short version

My answer: don't build yet.

Four outcomes are live and do nothing is one of them. Five proposed investigations could settle it in about three weeks, given access to Shopify's teams, a test store, usage data and merchants. One of them could stop the work in a day. Everything below is the working.

Jump to the plan →

4

Outcomes still live
Including doing nothing

5

Investigations
Proposed, in dependency order

3 Weeks

To a decision
An estimate that depends on access

1

Could stop it in a day
Shopify's original rationale

The question

Why does Shopify offer two ways to assign a B2B catalog to a company location, and when is each one right?

What's true

A B2B market can target one named company location *and* be scheduled through Rollouts. A direct assignment outranks it for overlapping products but **can't be scheduled at all.** Both deliver location-specific pricing.

So what

The higher-precedence mechanism is the one with no scheduling. Shopify documents the distinction and explains when each assignment route is appropriate. However, the plan comparison does not surface the Rollouts limitation alongside the Plus-only direct-assignment capability. Whether merchants connect these details before choosing a route, particularly in the actual setup flow, remains unvalidated.

Test regardless

Test whether merchants connect the details before choosing. If they don't, putting the Rollouts limitation next to the Plus-only capability is a content change, with no engineering.

The gap I'd flag before you find it: I have not spoken to a single Shopify merchant. Everything here is documentation, schema and public posts. That is the weakest part of this document, I know exactly which ten people I'd call, and I'd rather state it plainly here than have you discover it later.

Where I went wrong

Late in the work, I found out my claim was wrong.

In Shopify's own documentation, on a page I'd walked past three times. Here is where the investigation started, and where it landed.

Where it started: the thesis

Wrong

~~Plus merchants can't schedule per-customer prices~~

The case I first built, and the feature I designed to fix it.

~~Direct assignment is the only route~~

I assumed per-location pricing needed it. A market can target one location.

~~Rollouts edit prices on a date~~

They don't: they flip which prepared catalog is active.

~~$180–270M at stake~~

Every input underneath that number was invented.

Where it landed: what survived

Holds up

A market can serve one company location

Shopify documents it with a worked example: “Company Location A.”

Market catalogs can be scheduled

The capability exists, for the market route.

The override can't be

A direct catalog outranks markets for overlapping products, yet can't be a Rollout target.

Whether anyone needs both is unknown

That's an empirical question, and it's what the rest of this is for.

1 question

A reviewer asked whether a B2B market could target one company location

3 pages

Of Shopify's Help Center state the Rollouts restriction on direct catalogs

23 Oct 2026

When catalog Rollouts shipped, shortly before I wrote this

How it works

Where this ended up, in five steps.

Each step is a claim, and the small screen beside it is what the claim looks like in the product.

Step 1 of 5 · The context

In April 2026 Shopify brought B2B to every B2B-eligible plan.

Companies, catalogs, net terms and volume pricing are now on Basic, Grow and Advanced, not only Plus. Shopify kept a few capabilities for Plus, and one is `direct catalog assignment`: attaching a price list straight to one company location.

2 April 2026 | Plus-only by design

Shopify plan availability · April 2026

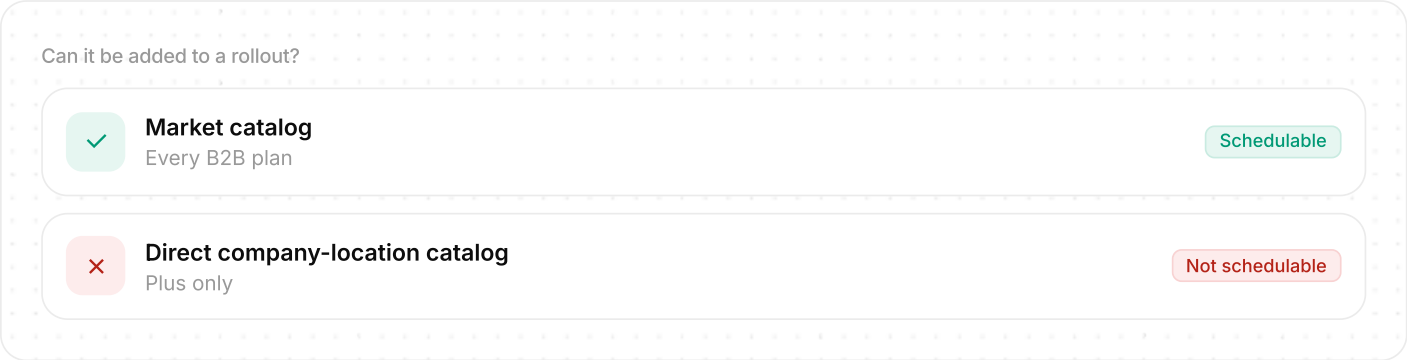
	Basic	Grow	Adv.	Plus
Companies, catalogs, net terms	✓	✓	✓	✓
Direct catalog assignment	—	—	—	✓

Step 2 of 5 · The asymmetry

Direct catalogs can't be scheduled. Market catalogs can.

Shopify's Help Center, stated three separate times: *"Direct company-location catalogs can't be added to a rollout."* Rollouts are how you schedule a catalog going live, time-box it, or test it. The Plus-only mechanism has none of that. This part holds up.

Verified on 3 pages

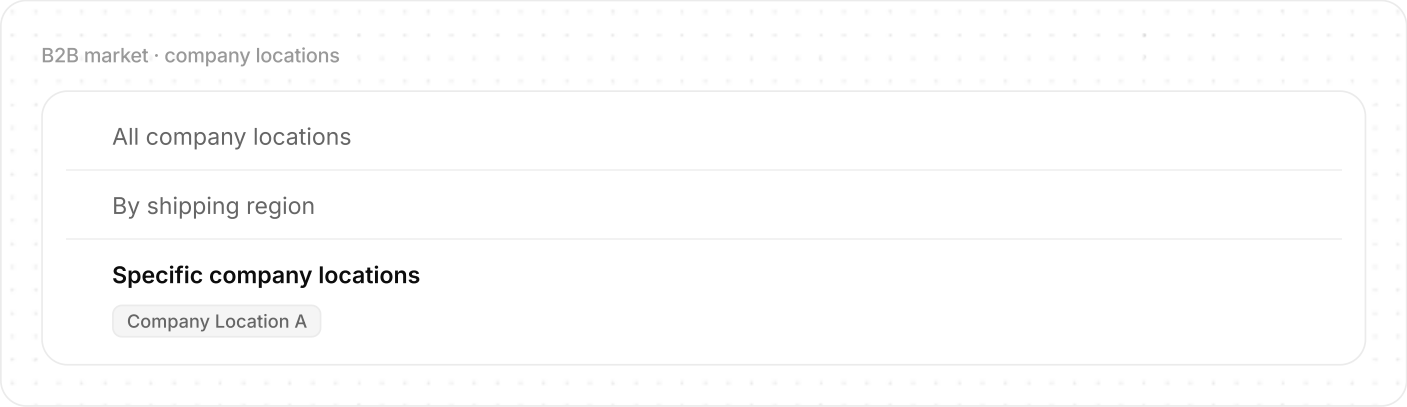


Step 3 of 5 · What broke my thesis

A market can be made for one single company location.

Shopify's own words: *"Specific company locations: includes only the company locations you specify."* Their own example market is called *"Company Location A, a market specifically for a single company location."* So a Plus merchant who wants scheduled per-customer pricing can already have it, through markets, not direct assignment.

Found late

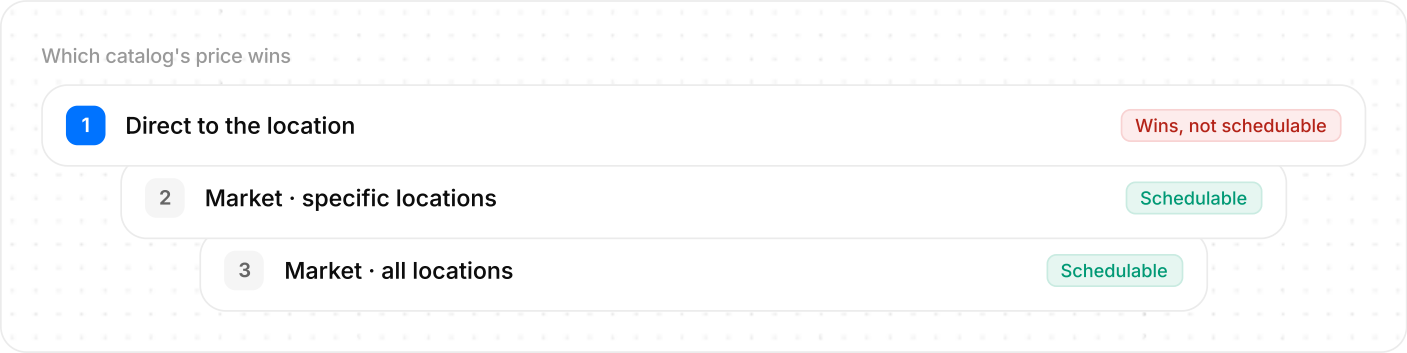


Step 4 of 5 · The sharper finding

Direct assignment is the override layer, and overrides can't be scheduled.

"A catalog assigned directly to the customer's company location takes precedence over market catalogs." Market catalogs can target groups or a specific location and can be scheduled. The direct-assigned catalog itself cannot be a Rollout target. The unresolved question is whether merchants need both properties for the same contract workflow.

Documented hierarchy



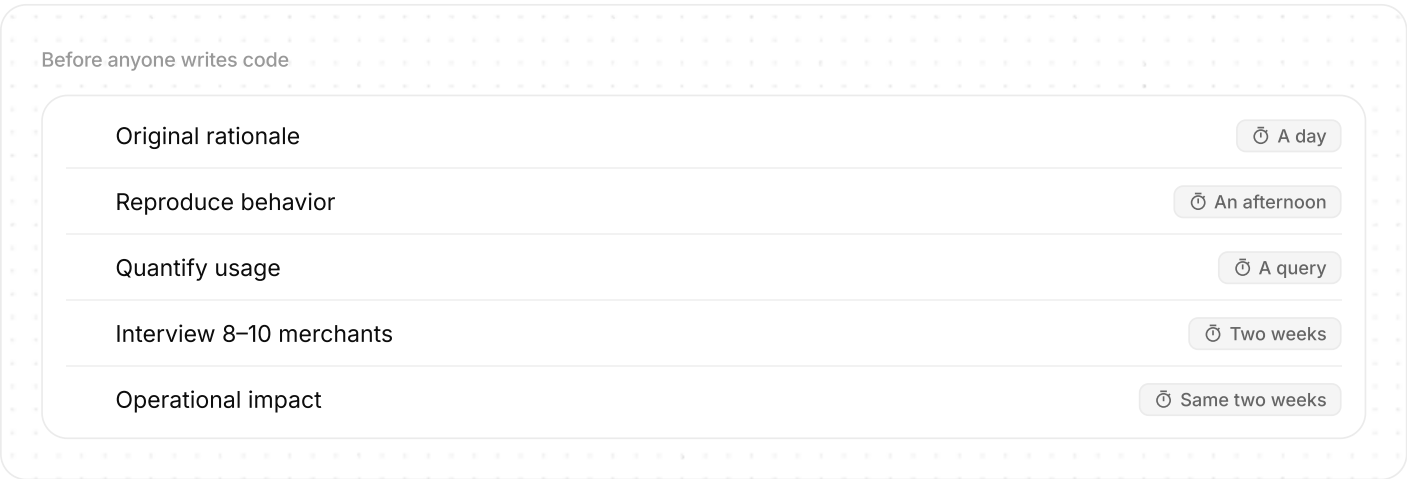
Step 5 of 5 · What I'd actually do

Not build anything yet. Five investigations first.

The workaround exists and its precedence is documented. A specific-location market is below direct assignment but above broader company-location and region markets. Whether merchants need the direct override and scheduled activation in the same workflow is an empirical question, section 07 has the five proposed investigations, in dependency order.

3 Weeks, given access

1 day-one stop check



01 · What's true

Start with what's actually true, because most writing about this gets it wrong.

The current state of Shopify B2B, taken only from Shopify's own Help Center. I'm starting here because I got two of these facts wrong myself early on, and so did every third-party blog I read while researching.

On 2 April 2026, Shopify extended B2B to Basic, Grow and Advanced at no extra cost. Company profiles, up to three custom catalogs with tailored pricing, volume discounts, quantity rules, vaulted cards and payment terms all moved down from Plus.

Shopify was explicit about what stayed behind.

This is the first thing I had to get right. At first I believed per-customer B2B pricing was Plus-only. That's false, a merchant on Basic can absolutely give different customers different prices. What's Plus-only is a narrower thing: attaching a catalog *directly* to one named company location, rather than routing it through a market.

Exhibit A shopify.com/news/b2b-for-all Source ↗

Shopify brings native B2B features to millions more merchants

Shopify Newsroom · 2 April 2026

"For merchants with established B2B businesses and more complex needs, Plus continues to offer full access to all Shopify B2B features. Plus merchants still get unlimited catalogs for customer-specific pricing, direct catalog assignment to companies and locations, partial payments, and deposits."

Why this matters: direct catalog assignment being Plus-only is deliberate, stated, and monetized. Any case study that attacks that boundary is arguing against a decision Shopify published on purpose. Mine doesn't.

The plans, and the row the plan comparison leaves out

Prices: shopify.com/pricing · Features: Help Center · Nov 2026

Basic

For solo entrepreneurs

$29 / month

B2B ON BASIC:

- **3** active catalog assignments to B2B markets
- Direct company catalogs: not available
- Schedule a direct catalog with Rollouts: not available
- **25** catalogs per company location
- **10,000** catalogs per store

Grow

For small teams

$89 / month

B2B ON GROW:

- **3** active catalog assignments to B2B markets
- Direct company catalogs: not available
- Schedule a direct catalog with Rollouts: not available
- **25** catalogs per company location
- **10,000** catalogs per store

Advanced

For global reach

$359 / month

B2B ON ADVANCED:

- **3** active catalog assignments to B2B markets
- Direct company catalogs: not available
- Schedule a direct catalog with Rollouts: not available
- **25** catalogs per company location
- **10,000** catalogs per store

Plus

For complex businesses

from **$2,300** / month

B2B ON PLUS:

- **Unlimited** active catalog assignments to B2B markets
- Direct company catalogs **included**
- Schedule a direct catalog with Rollouts: **not supported**
  Stated on a different Help Center page
- **25** catalogs per company location
- **10,000** catalogs per store
  Marketed as “Unlimited B2B catalogs”

Plan names, taglines and prices from shopify.com/pricing. Catalog rows from Shopify B2B features by plan. **The Rollouts row appears on neither.** It comes from a third page, B2B catalogs with Markets, and that gap is part of the argument.

Two hard limits worth writing down

These are easy to get wrong, and I did get them wrong the first time. From Shopify's companies documentation: a company location can hold a maximum of **50 customers** and a maximum of **25 catalogs**.

Two more scale constraints matter to the workaround: Shopify documents a maximum of **10,000 catalogs per store**, and its developer guide describes a *two-catalog pattern* that separates pricing from product publication to reduce catalog duplication. So catalog

count, location count and price-list count must be measured independently; a 1:1 account-to-catalog assumption is not safe.

Catalogs per company location

25 max

The ceiling a one-location-market workaround has to live under.



25 slots, direct and market combined

Customers per company location

50 max

I worked from the wrong number at first.



What an agency blog said: 10 Shopify's real limit: 50

Catalogs per store

10,000

A ceiling the plan page doesn't show.

"Unlimited" on pricing



Market assignments

3 active

Basic, Grow, Advanced. No cap on Plus.

∞ on Plus



Correction log

I worked from "10 customers per company location" at first. That number came from a third-party agency blog and it is wrong. I'm leaving the correction visible because the habit of checking a vendor blog against the vendor's own documentation is the only reason I found the actual problem.

What Plus costs, and what it lists

A published floor

Shopify's pricing page lists Plus at **"Starts at $2,300 USD/mo."** The same page notes that *"if you choose a 1- or 3-year Plus subscription, you can cancel when your term commitment expires"*, so term commitments exist, but **it does not publish a price for each term.** Higher-volume businesses move to a variable platform fee, so $2,300 is a published floor rather than a universal merchant cost.

No price per term

Partners and agencies widely report a higher monthly rate on the shorter term. **I'm not stating those figures as Shopify's, because Shopify doesn't print them**, and this document already carries a correction log about the last time I trusted an agency number. Nothing in the argument depends on the exact figure, only on Plus costing materially more than Advanced, which Shopify confirms by making it a separate tier.

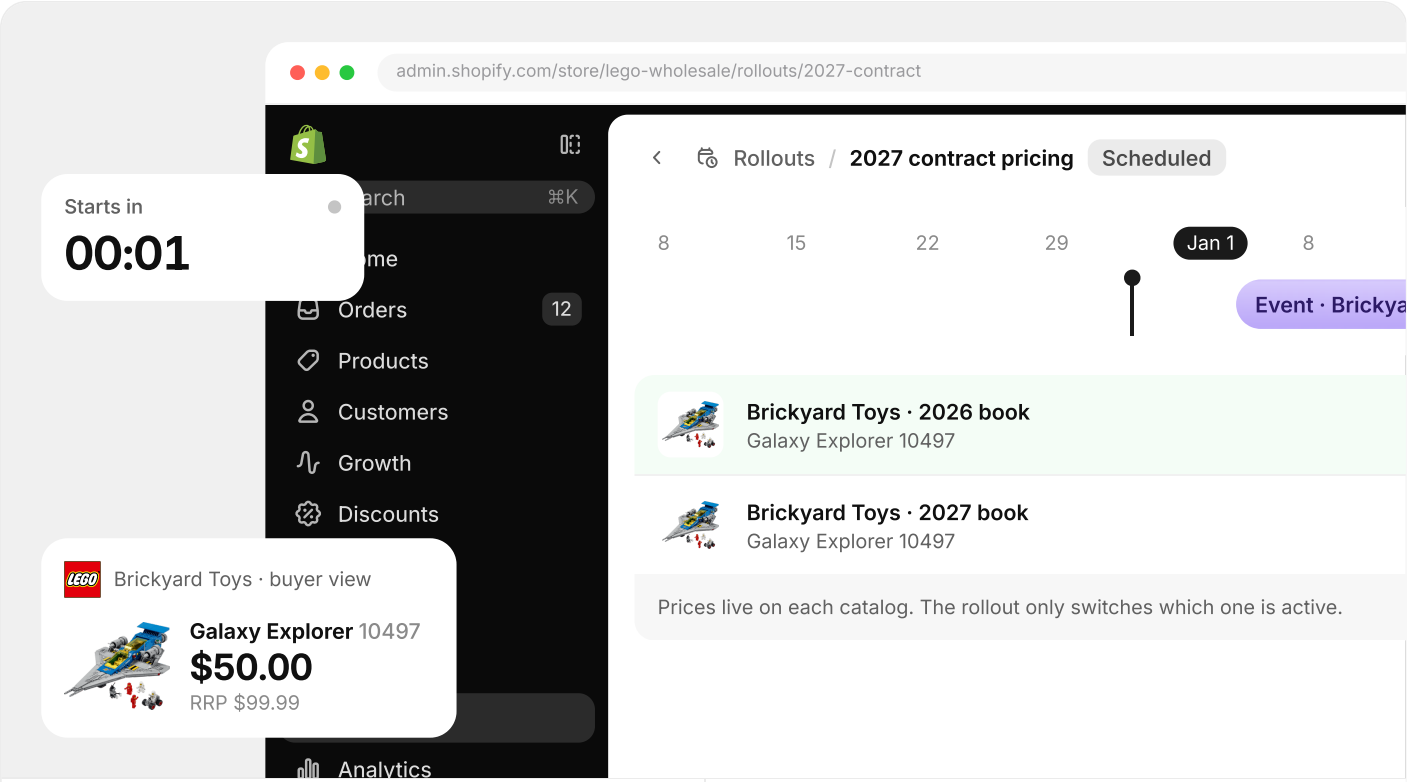
"Unlimited", with a ceiling

The Plus pricing page markets **"Unlimited B2B catalogs"**, while the detailed help documentation sets a 10,000-total-catalog ceiling per store and a 25-catalog ceiling per company location. The mechanism distinction, direct company-location assignment versus market assignment, appears on the plan page, but the Rollouts restriction is documented separately.

02 · The finding

One sentence, buried in a help article.

Rollouts are how you schedule a change on Shopify, a theme, a checkout config, a discount, or a catalog going live on a date. They are, in Shopify's own framing, the mechanism for planned change.



I got this wrong first

A rollout doesn't edit prices. It swaps which catalog is live.

A rollout applies a treatment-level activation for a *prepared* catalog, Active or Draft for the buyers served by that treatment, without changing the catalog's native status. Price edits save immediately, whether or not a rollout is running. An Event rollback reverts the activation, not a previous snapshot of prices.

The fine print

A catalog can be part of only one unended rollout at a time. A market catalog can be added before it is assigned to a market, but affects no customers until one is. A direct-catalog target would need a different eligibility rule, based on company location. And the swap carries its own questions: how the revised catalog is prepared, what happens if only some activations succeed, and how conflicting assignments are prevented.

So a scheduled price change is really a **catalog swap**: duplicate the catalog, edit the copy, schedule a rollout that activates the copy and drafts the original. The old prices survive because the old catalog is still sitting there in draft.

Illustrative recreation of the Shopify admin, hypothetical merchant. Not a live account screenshot. LEGO isn't a Shopify customer; its Galaxy Explorer set (US launch price as announced by LEGO: $99.99) is shown on a one-location B2B market for a fictional toy retailer, with invented contract prices. Watch the clock: the rollout flips Active and Draft, from the $50.00 book to the $46.40 book, and the price on each catalog never changes.

Three pages, one native-platform constraint

All three read 5 November 2026

help.shopify.com/en/manual/b2b/markets/catal Open ↗

Exhibit B, the finding. Highlight added; text unchanged.

Exhibit C, corroboration help.shopify.com/manual/... Source ↗

Catalogs and pricing in B2B

Overview page

"You can use a rollout to schedule a catalog's status change only for a catalog that you create for a market. A catalog that's assigned directly to a company or a company location can't be added to a rollout."

Second page, same constraint. Not a documentation slip or a stale article.

Exhibit D, third confirmation help.shopify.com/man... Source ↗

Customizing B2B pricing using catalogs

Section: "Create a catalog"

"If you want to schedule the catalog's status changes with a rollout, then assign the catalog to a B2B market. Catalogs assigned directly to company locations can't be added to a rollout."

This page gives the native path: assign the catalog to a B2B market. That doesn't make direct assignment inferior, it has higher precedence and suits tailored relationships. The merchant needs to see the trade-off before choosing.

I found no Shopify Rollouts path for directly assigned catalogs. That doesn't rule out ERP or app-based orchestration through APIs, separate workflows with their own scheduling, reliability and recovery responsibilities. CSV import is a bulk-edit path, not scheduled activation. **On screenshots:** I've reproduced exact wording rather than pasting images, because Shopify revises help articles and a quote with a live link stays checkable.

The two routes have different precedence and scheduling properties. The question is whether merchants need both properties in the same workflow.

What the direct-assignment route cannot do today

A catalog assigned directly to a company location cannot itself be added to a Rollout. That is a real product asymmetry, but it is **not** a blanket loss of scheduled per-customer pricing: a merchant can create a B2B market scoped to a specific company location and schedule a market catalog through Rollouts.

The caveat is precedence. Shopify's developer documentation ranks a directly assigned company-location catalog above a specific-company-location market catalog. If both apply to the same buyer and product, the direct catalog remains the higher-priority source. A scheduled market catalog cannot be assumed to change the visible price for products still covered by a direct assignment.

Before you ask: is this big enough to matter?

It's the first question I'd ask too, and I want to answer it before arguing anything else rather than burying it on page six.

Honestly: I don't know yet, and neither does anyone outside Shopify. The size depends on how many Plus merchants use direct catalogs and how often they reprice, two numbers that only exist inside Shopify's database. Section 07 is built entirely around getting them, and includes the condition under which I'd kill my own proposal.

My planning estimate for initial discovery is about three weeks and two internal usage queries, an estimate to validate with the team, not a delivery commitment, and materially smaller than funding a build before establishing the cohort and workflow.

In scope

Launch

A market catalog can be scheduled to become Active or Draft for its eligible audience. A direct-assigned catalog cannot be included as the change target.

In scope

Event

A market catalog can be scheduled for a time window and its activation status can revert. This does not restore an earlier price snapshot; catalog price edits save immediately.

100% only

Audience allocation

Rollouts can apply to a percentage of eligible visitors, assigned at random. For a negotiated company-location price, the concept assumes 100% of eligible buyers at that location, a proposed requirement, not an existing direct-catalog Rollouts capability. Partial allocation is out of scope.

Out of scope

Experiment

Don't extend this to B2B negotiated pricing without validating the allocation unit and price consistency for all buyers at a company location.

NOT THE UNRESOLVED QUESTION

Whether Shopify can schedule location-specific prices. It can, through a location-specific market. Existing Rollouts derive their audience from the markets associated with the catalog change; a direct-catalog extension would need a company-location audience model.

THE UNRESOLVED QUESTION

Whether merchants who deliberately use direct assignment need its higher precedence for overlapping products *and* also need timed activation.

The scale of that cohort and its workload are unknown; 240 locations do not imply 240 unique catalogs or 240 manual operations.

03 · What broke it

The finding that broke my own thesis.

I had the proposal written. Extend Rollouts to direct catalogs, here's the ship plan, here's what I'd promise. Then I went back through the Markets documentation to check something unrelated, and found the paragraph that invalidated it.

I'm putting it here, at the front, rather than in a footnote, because how a PM handles the evidence that kills their own idea is more informative than the idea was.

Exhibit E, what I missed help.shopify.com/manual/... Source ↗

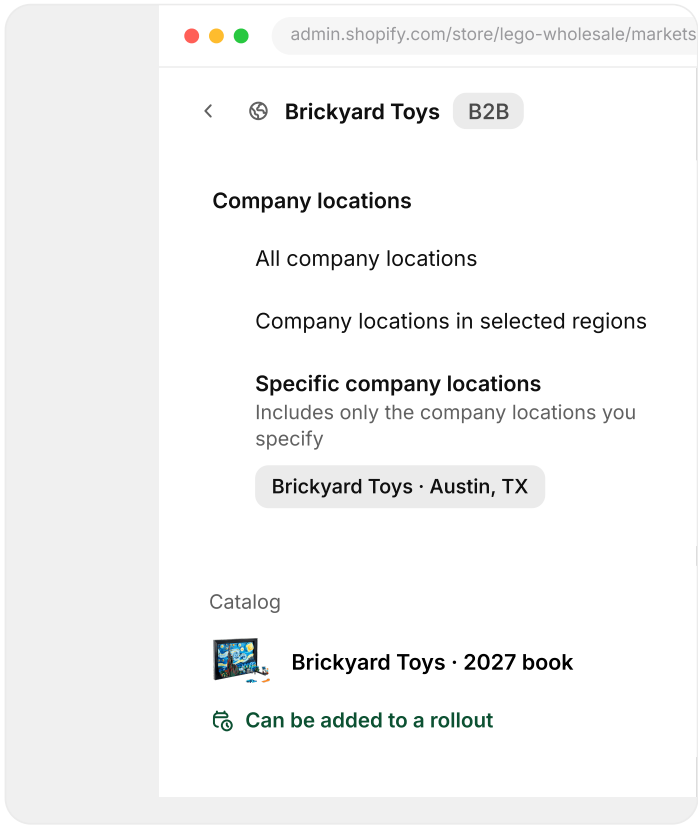
Understanding market types

Section: "B2B markets"

"You can include company locations in B2B markets in three different ways: ... Specific company locations: Includes only the company locations you specify, regardless of where they're shipping to."

"For example, your store contains the following markets: Company Location A, a market specifically for a single company location."

Shopify documents a market containing exactly one company location. A catalog assigned to it can be scheduled through Rollouts. On Plus the three-assignment cap doesn't apply, though the 25-per-location and 10,000-per-store limits still matter. This provides scheduled location-specific pricing, subject to the precedence hierarchy.



The single most important page in the document, found late. My proposal assumed direct assignment was the only route to per-customer pricing. It isn't, and Shopify says so in the same Help Center I'd been quoting all week. Right: an illustrative recreation of a B2B market scoped to one fictional toy retailer (LEGO used as a hypothetical merchant), not a live account screenshot.

What this kills, and what survives

Claim I made	Verdict	Why
Plus merchants cannot schedule a direct-assigned catalog	True, with an alternative	A market catalog scoped to one company location can be scheduled, but it has lower precedence than a direct assignment for overlapping products.
Rollouts are a scheduled price-edit and rollback engine	False	A rollout applies a treatment-level Active/Draft activation without changing the catalog's native status. Price edits save immediately; a rollback reverts activation, not old prices.
240 accounts means 240 manual operations	Unsupported	One catalog can serve many locations. I never established the real catalog count.
Direct company-location catalogs can't be added to a rollout	Verified	On three separate Shopify pages. Unchanged.
The plan comparison page explains the scheduling trade-off	False	The plan matrix lists direct assignment as a Plus feature but doesn't pair it with the Rollouts limitation, which is documented separately.
Shopify's documentation gives no choice guidance	False	Correction: the B2B catalogs guide says markets suit broader strategies and direct catalogs suit tailored relationships. The open question is whether scheduling and precedence are easy to connect across the plan, catalog and Rollouts pages.

The better question underneath

Not obsolete either

Losing the thesis exposed something sharper than the thesis was. My next instinct was that markets now dominate direct assignment on every axis, which would make direct assignment obsolete. That's wrong too, and the reason it's wrong is the interesting part.

The published hierarchy

Shopify's developer documentation spells out the full precedence hierarchy (Pricing prioritization). Only catalogs at the highest applicable level are considered; if several tie there, the lower price is used. The resolver below uses exactly that rule.

Catalogs combine, prices override

One distinction I nearly got wrong. A direct catalog doesn't replace a market catalog wholesale. Shopify: *"If the catalogs include different products, then all products from each catalog are displayed."* The catalogs *combine*, and precedence decides the price only where the same product appears in both, **a higher-priority pricing override for overlapping products, not a replacement for the entire market catalog.**

help.shopify.com/en/manual/b2b/markets/c Open ↗

Exhibit F, direct wins. Highlight added; text unchanged.

TRY THE RESOLVER

- **Keep the direct catalog on** and switch to Jan 1. The rollout lowers the market price to $46.40, and the buyer still pays the direct $52.00.
- **Precedence, not the lowest price, decides.** The cheaper market catalog loses because direct assignment sits on a higher level.
- **Switch the direct catalog off.** Now the scheduled market catalog decides the price.
- **The rule it applies:** only the highest applicable level counts; ties take the lower price.



LEGO set and retail price are real; LEGO isn't a Shopify merchant, and the retailer and contract prices are illustrative.

Brickyard Toys pays · Galaxy Explorer 10497

Direct catalog wins

$52.00

The rollout lowered the market price to $46.40 · the buyer still pays $52.00, because the direct catalog outranks it even at a higher price.

1	Direct to t... Brickyard To...	Not schedulable	$52.00
2	Market · spec... Brickyard Toys ...	Schedulable	~~$46.40~~
3	Market · all co... Toy retailers · US	Schedulable	~~$55.00~~
4	Region marke... Not used here	Schedulable	—
5	Region marke... Not used here	Schedulable	—
6	App catalog Online Store · retail		~~$99.99~~

Direct assignment isn't a redundant version of markets. It's a higher-priority pricing override.

Scenario, Shopify's own candle examples	Which price the buyer sees	Example
Two catalogs assigned directly to the same location	The lowest price wins	$9 and $7 → buyer sees **$7**
A direct catalog and a matching market catalog	The direct catalog wins, as the more specific price	$9 direct, $7 via market → buyer sees **$9**
Two market catalogs, both matching	The more specific market wins; if equally specific, the lower price	"All locations shipping to the US" beats "all locations in all countries"

Shopify documents both candle examples under separate headings. The model is coherent: direct outranks a matching market for overlapping products; ties at the same level take the lower price.

The context-based route

Market assignment

It can cover groups of company locations or a specific location, and its catalogs can be scheduled through Rollouts.

The exception

Direct assignment

The individually negotiated deal that overrides the book on the products it covers, at a documented higher priority.

So Shopify can schedule market catalogs, including catalogs scoped to one company location. It cannot schedule the direct-assignment override itself. The product question is whether merchants need both properties at once.

This is the narrower finding I can defend after correcting the precedence model. Whether an individually negotiated contract needs the direct override *and* a specific go-live time is the unresolved customer question.

And the workaround isn't actually equivalent

A real alternative, not an equivalent

A market scoped to one company location can be scheduled and is more specific than broader company-location and region markets. It is a real alternative when a merchant needs location-specific pricing without a direct override. It is **not equivalent** where the merchant relies on a directly assigned catalog taking precedence over that market.

Documented, not ambiguous

The hierarchy is documented, not ambiguous. I had missed the developer documentation that states it explicitly. Investigation 2 should now test the implementation against that published hierarchy and inspect the resulting buyer experience, not pretend the ordering is unknown.

What to validate

The question to validate is practical: which real merchant setups depend on direct assignment winning over a market catalog for overlapping products, and how often do they need a timed change? If no meaningful cohort needs both, there may be no engineering opportunity. If they do, a market workaround is not sufficient for those products while the direct catalog remains assigned.

A number I am deliberately not using

Several third-party sources, agencies and migration guides, state that a Shopify store supports a maximum of **50 markets**. If true, that would cap the workaround neatly, and it would have been very convenient for my argument.

I could not confirm it on any Shopify page, and there is evidence against it. Shopify's developer documentation discusses a limit on *wildcard* markets, a different thing, and a 2025 developer forum response indicates the older 50-market figure no longer applies.

So: **the official documentation I reviewed does not establish a global limit on individually specified company-location markets.** This is the second agency number that would have helped me if I'd believed it. I believed the first one and was wrong.

Why I didn't delete the case study

I considered deleting the build proposal. What remains is a smaller discovery case and a possible information-design improvement.

This isn't missing documentation. Shopify explains when each route fits; what's unvalidated is whether merchants connect the Rollouts limitation with the Plus-only capability before choosing, which section 05 takes up.

The mechanisms have different semantics, and that distinction may be deliberate, I can't infer Shopify's rationale from public docs. The next step is to test whether merchants understand the trade-off and whether it affects a real workflow. A concise decision guide on the plan and setup surfaces may be justified even if no engineering is.

So the rest of this document is no longer a proposal. It's the case for spending about three weeks finding out, and the four outcomes that could follow, one of which is doing nothing.

04 · Who this hurts

Six public signals. Not six merchants.

I have not interviewed a Shopify merchant, and I'm not going to invent personas and call them research. So I went looking for people who had already written about this in public, where anyone can check them.

Before the quotes, I want to be precise about what this evidence is, because my instinct was to present it as stronger than it is, and that instinct is worth naming.

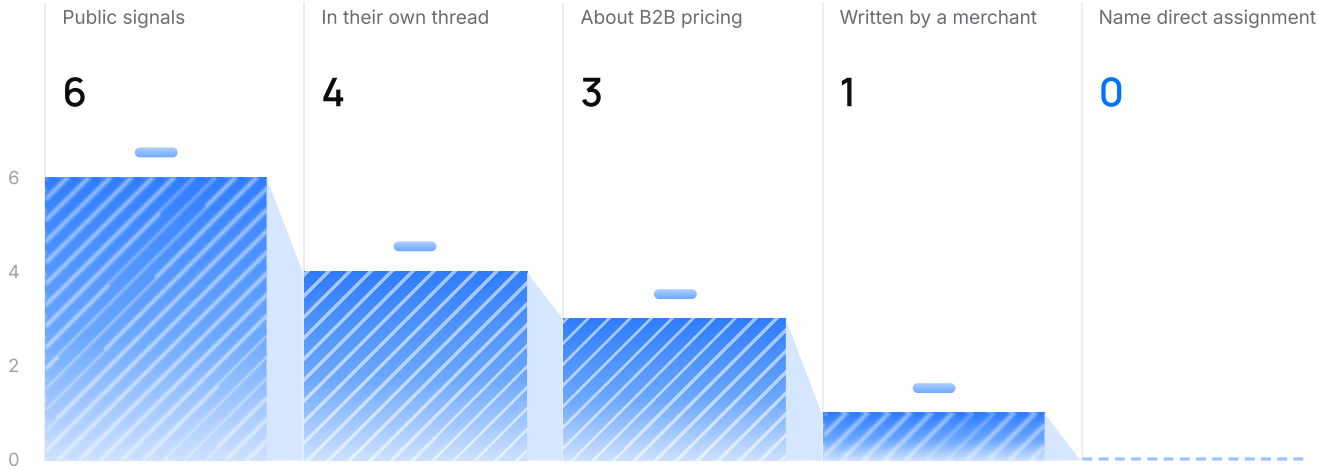
What this evidence is, and is not

It would be easy to call these "six merchants" and say six independent voices demonstrate the same failure. **That overstates it.** Two are replies in a single thread, one is a developer validating an app concept, and one is a poster reporting research into D2C bulk-price app reviews, not B2B catalogs. The Plus merchant's post doesn't say whether the four catalogs were directly or market-assigned, nor whether scheduling was the problem.

More importantly: **not one of them establishes that direct catalog assignment caused their problem.** They describe pain in the neighborhood of my thesis. That's a reason to go and ask the right people, not a substitute for having asked them. I'm keeping the quotes because they're real and checkable; I'm removing the claim that they validate my proposal.

Six public signals, filtered step by step

Nobody names direct catalogs, and nobody asks for scheduling.



Each step follows the case study's own reading of the posts. By the last step nothing is left: nobody names direct assignment or asks for scheduling, which is why investigation 4 exists. Hover a step.

Show the six public signals in full

Every quote, linked, with what each supports, plus the review breakdown



Six public voices, every one linked

3 posts · 2 replies · 1 developer validating an app



EVP
Shopify Plus merchant · 17 Dec 2024

Zero replies

Managing B2B Catalog Pricing, any tools out there?

"We currently have 4 catalogs and have plans to add more but are a bit concerned about the time it's going to manage all of them. Are there no tools out there for bulk uploading pricing for multiple catalogs?"

"We should really be able to update a products catalog pricing on the actual product page."

What it supports: a Plus merchant with four B2B catalogs reported management overhead and asked about bulk price updates. The post doesn't say whether the catalogs were direct or market-assigned, how many locations they served, or whether scheduling was the need. The absence of replies is a forum observation, not evidence Shopify lacks a feature. A lead for an interview, not proof of the direct-catalog cohort.



lu_judy
Shopify Community · 679 views · 24 Jul 2026

B2B Catalog Price Change webhook / Flow trigger

"Please add a Flow trigger or webhook for B2B Catalog Price changes, similar to the existing Product Variant Price Changed trigger."

Shopify's thread summary notes the request would *"reduce reliance on scheduled polling or manual checks,"* with no timeline given. **What it supports:** an automation need. A webhook is not scheduled activation, and doesn't establish demand for Rollouts on direct catalogs.



Bryce_David
Shopify Community · 1 Aug 2026

D2C, not B2B

I read 109 negative reviews of bulk price apps

"Spent an afternoon reading every 1 to 3 star review I could find across 17 apps ... 109 reviews total, 97 of them 1 or 2 stars."

"Bulk price editors: **the failure is almost never the price change itself. It's the undo.**"

"One merchant said a revert only restored about a quarter of their store and they had to fix the rest by hand."

"About 12 reviews describe partial variant updates specifically, the job reports success but only some variants actually moved. One merchant found out **because a customer bought something at the wrong price** before anyone noticed internally."

What it signals: rollback and execution visibility are the recurring failure in third-party bulk-price tools. Adjacent evidence about bulk-edit risk, not about Shopify B2B catalog assignment, and not something I'd use to validate the proposal.



Ian_Chechin
Reply in the same thread · 1 Sep 2026

Reply

"If the app applied 4,000 of 5,000 changes and timed out, its undo replays the same pipeline against the same API limits, so it times out the same way, except now the catalog is in **a third state neither you nor the app has a name for**."

Why it matters: a third-party undo is another write loop against the same rate limits, while a platform-side rollout flips which catalog is serving instead of replaying writes. It argues for a platform capability in general, not for this specific one.

zhouhua1998071
Same thread · 4 Sep 2026

Reply

"Without a per-variant record of intended / updated / skipped / failed, **a job that ends early looks identical to a job that finished.** The merchant only finds out when a customer points at a price."

What it supports: a bulk-edit job that looked successful despite incomplete execution, found late. An adjacent reliability signal, not corroboration of a B2B direct-assignment problem.

UndoB2B
Developer validating an app · 12 Sep 2026

Nobody has bought it

Planned price: $39/month, refundable deposit to join the beta

"The problem I'm looking at is **B2B pricing mistakes.** If prices are changed by mistake during a bulk edit or import, I'd like to make it easy to see what changed and restore the previous pricing state."

"If someone accidentally overwrote a large batch of B2B prices today, how would you recover?"

Stated precisely: a developer scoped an app, named it after the missing verb, *undo*, and is validating demand at a planned price. It's a bet about where someone thinks the pain is, not evidence of paying customers.

Sample: D2C apps, not B2B

109

negative reviews read across 17 bulk-price apps

As reported by one Shopify Community poster, 1 Aug 2026 · read the post

★★☆☆☆

97
rated 1 or 2 stars

89% of the reviews

★★★☆☆

12
rated 3 stars

11% of the reviews

≈12
describe partial variant updates

The poster's estimate

EVP

DEMONSTRATES
Concern about the time to manage four B2B catalogs; asked about bulk-upload tools

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE
That direct assignment was the cause, or that scheduling was what he wanted

lu_judy

DEMONSTRATES
Demand for price-change webhooks on B2B catalogs

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE
Demand for scheduled activation



Bryce_David

DEMONSTRATES

Rollback, not the edit, is the dominant failure in bulk tooling

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE

That direct B2B catalogs have this problem, his sample is D2C apps



Ian_Chechin

DEMONSTRATES

Why third-party undo struggles: it replays writes against the same limits

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE

Independent merchant demand, a technical reply



zhouhua1998071

DEMONSTRATES

Missing per-variant execution visibility

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE

Demand for this specific solution; also a reply



UndoB2B

DEMONSTRATES

A developer believes B2B price recovery is worth charging for

DOES NOT DEMONSTRATE

Paying merchant demand, it is a bet

Writing this table changed how I read my own evidence. Collectively these point at a real neighborhood of pain, bulk price changes are risky and hard to reverse, but none is about the thing I claimed.

Adjacent third-party tooling, not proof of this gap

I found apps for bulk price editing, backups, snapshots and recovery. They show that merchants and developers build tools around bulk-price operations. They do **not** establish that these tools support Shopify's native B2B catalog objects, that their users are Plus merchants, or that direct company-location catalogs are the unmet need.

UndoB2B's public material described a validation-stage product at a proposed $39/month; not evidence of paying customers. I wouldn't add any tool's price or feature claims to a business case without checking each listing and its exact B2B compatibility.

One public request asks for scheduling and reverting bulk product-price edits, a useful D2C workflow signal, but not a definition of native B2B catalog Rollouts, which apply treatment-level activation, not changes to stored prices.

What I couldn't find

Nobody wrote "I wish I could put a rollout on a company-location catalog." Not one person. I searched the forums, the feature-request board, YouTube comments, Reddit, X and LinkedIn. The sentence does not exist.

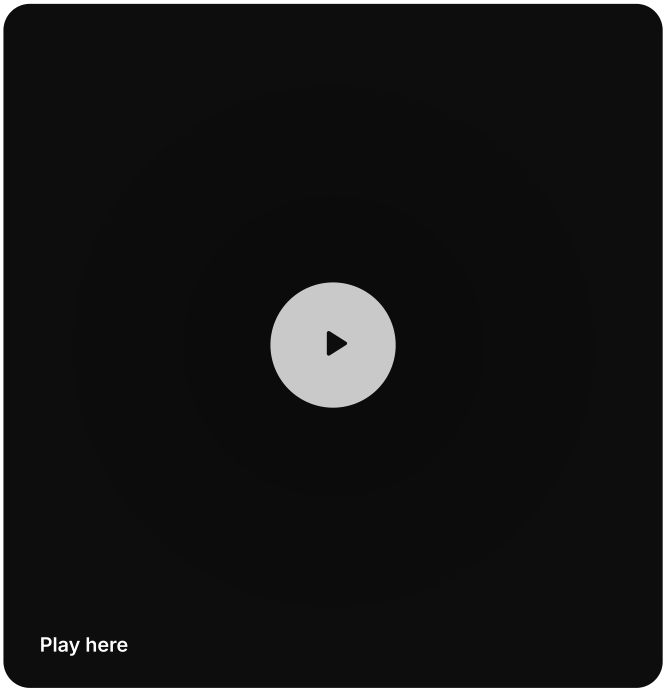
Reading one, it isn't a real problem. If it mattered, someone would have asked. That's the reading I'd expect a skeptical reviewer to take, and I can't disprove it from public data.

What the evidence supports: several adjacent signals, catalog-management workload, requests for price-change events, complaints about bulk-edit recovery, interest in snapshots. Enough to justify targeted interviews; not enough to justify a build. EVP's thread is the clearest case, and even there I can't infer whether he wants a native feature, an app or a better workflow.

This is why investigation 4 is interviews, not ticket analysis. "What did you do last January" surfaces this. Reading support tickets never will, because nobody files a ticket about a workaround that works.

Show the walkthrough video and Shopify's published merchant quotes

Secondary exhibits: context on B2B pricing operations, not validation of this gap



The one walkthrough I found · 284 views

How To Bulk Update Wholesale Prices On Shopify

ONHOW Studio · 12 Apr 2026 · 3:03

0:03 "Managing a massive wholesale catalog can be exhausting when rates change."

Method 1 A blanket percentage adjustment, fine if every price moves the same, useless for renegotiated accounts.

Method 2 Export to CSV, edit in a spreadsheet, re-import. The real workflow for anything specific.

2:21 "If you use Gemini, make sure to double-check, otherwise you might make mistakes and you lose money."

What it shows: percentage adjustments and CSV export/edit/re-import. It doesn't demonstrate scheduled activation, a staged swap or recovery, but a short tutorial isn't a product audit; its silence isn't evidence merchants need those things. One demonstrated workflow, not proof it's the only one. Quotes from the video's captions, 5 Nov 2026; low view count stated deliberately.

Shopify's own merchants

Two merchants Shopify chose to publish.

Forum posts are evidence of friction. Shopify's own published quotes are evidence that Shopify already agrees the friction is real, context on B2B operations, not validation of this scheduling gap.

Exhibit G · DAX Eyewear shopify.com/news/b2b-f... Source ↗

When pricing is maintained by hand, buyers stop trusting it

Justin Dyson, co-runs DAX Eyewear with Channing Dyson · April 2026

"While depending on workarounds to manage wholesale, DAX found that buyers would sometimes see retail prices instead of their negotiated rates. So some never placed an order at all.", "If you can't trust the data, you can't make good decisions."

Context only. DAX described a pre-native-B2B problem. It shows why correct B2B pricing matters; it's not evidence about direct-catalog scheduling.

Exhibit H · Snyder Performance Engineering Source ↗

Back-office time is the constraint on how many accounts you can carry

Amy Snyder · quoted by Shopify, April 2026

Before Shopify, "every one of Snyder's B2B orders required a phone call or email instead of customers self-serving. This limited how many accounts they could process."

Back-office time

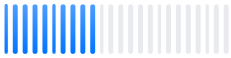
25 % less time



After moving to native B2B

Average customer spend

40 % higher



As published by Shopify

What this contributes: operational improvements can matter to B2B merchants. It doesn't establish that the Rollouts asymmetry creates the same cost, nor that direct-catalog users are the highest-account cohort.

Why I'd rather borrow real merchants than invent my own. An interviewer can check every one of these. They can't check a persona I made up. Where I extrapolate beyond what they said, I've marked it.

Potential buyer impact, a hypothesis

A pricing workflow that changes at the wrong time could expose a buyer to an outdated or unintended price, but I have no direct observation that this happens to merchants using direct company-location catalogs.

One technical caveat: scheduling a market catalog does not override an applicable direct-assigned

The two merchant shapes most exposed

Not research personas. **Both could use either mechanism**, so the question isn't precision versus timing. It's which route is practical. Four questions to brief a researcher on:

1. Does maintaining many single-location markets create real overhead, or does it just sound like it would?

catalog. If the direct catalog remains active for an overlapping product, the buyer may keep seeing the direct price. Any workflow must preview the buyer's *resolved* price, not just the status of the catalog being scheduled.

DAX's buyers seeing retail instead of negotiated prices is context for why accuracy matters, **not evidence** the Rollouts limitation causes the same outcome. Validate through storefront tests, order examples and interviews.

2. Does direct assignment make a negotiated relationship easier to express and maintain?
3. Does its higher precedence matter in practice, when a location also matches broader markets?
4. Do catalog limits, product availability and market configuration favor one route at scale? *(Each location caps at 25 catalogs, direct and market combined.)*

Hypothesis 1 The account-managed distributor

Many accounts, individually negotiated, repriced on a calendar

An illustrative Plus merchant with many wholesale company locations and individually negotiated price lists; cohort size and catalog distribution unknown. Prices move on contract anniversaries and at the start of the financial year.

If they chose direct assignment for its precedence, the scheduling gap is a real cost. If it was just the obvious way to make a customer price list, the fix is guidance, not engineering. **It would be easy to write that direct assignment is "the only mechanism that fits". It isn't**, investigation 4 decides which.

Hypothesis 2 The seasonal wholesaler

Time-boxed pricing is the whole business model

Trade-show pricing, pre-season books and end-of-line clearances are plausible time-boxed workflows. Both routes express location-specific prices; only the market route supports Rollouts.

What to test: whether merchants need the direct override during seasonal events. Don't infer a manual promotion workflow just because a catalog was activated and deactivated within 60 days, inspect the change history and merchant intent first.

I should not assume the market route is cumbersome. I should find out whether merchants experience it that way.

05 · Why it's this way

Why I stopped assuming it was an oversight.

An asymmetry in the product does not tell me why it exists. It may reflect deliberate product differentiation, a workflow boundary, launch scope, or technical constraints that aren't visible in public documentation. These are hypotheses to test, not explanations I can claim as fact.

The short version of the technical read. Shopify's public Admin GraphQL schema types the catalog in a rollout change as the shared `Catalog` interface, which direct and market catalogs both implement.

- **One plausible reading: market-only was a launch scope, not a verdict.** Catalog scheduling launched with market-based eligibility. That may reflect how catalog audiences and pricing contexts are

That suggests a common read-side model. It does not prove rollout mutations accept direct catalogs; engineering would have to validate the write path.

Then I checked when this shipped: 23 October 2026, shortly before I wrote this. "Per market" is the whole boundary, stated in the launch note without comment. This isn't legacy debt; it's a new feature scoped to one of two catalog types.

resolved, but the changelog does not explain why direct-assigned catalogs were excluded. Rollouts also supports other resource types, so I should not describe the entire Rollouts system as having originated inside Markets. *It's a hypothesis for investigation 1, no stronger than the other three below.*

- **What I should not claim:** that a team is working in this code now. I have no visibility into roadmaps or staffing.
- **The timing is the argument.** Market-assigned catalogs can be scheduled across eligible B2B plans. Plus-only direct company-location catalogs cannot be added to native Rollouts. The distinction is between assignment models, not free versus premium plans, and it's most useful to raise in the weeks after launch, before workarounds settle into "how it works."

Show the technical detail: what the public GraphQL schema does and doesn't show

Schema excerpts, a correction I made, and why the read-side type isn't proof

I went looking for evidence on both sides. Then I stopped guessing about the architecture and read the schema, because Shopify publishes it.

My working explanation for a while was an educated guess: rollouts probably belong to the Markets object model, direct catalogs hang off Company Locations, and the two don't meet. It read plausibly. It was also unfalsifiable, which should have bothered me sooner.

First: `Catalog` is a GraphQL *interface* (Admin API 2026-10), implemented by `AppCatalog`, `CompanyLocationCatalog` and `MarketCatalog`. Six of eight fields are identical. The two that matter differ by exactly one thing: **which object they attach to.** Neither has a rollout field; the word "rollout" appears zero times on either page.

```
# Plus only · direct assignment
type CompanyLocationCatalog {
  ± companyLocations
  ± companyLocationsCount
    id: ID!
    operations: [ResourceOperation!]!
    priceList: PriceList
    publication: Publication
    status: CatalogStatus! # shared
    title: String!
}
```

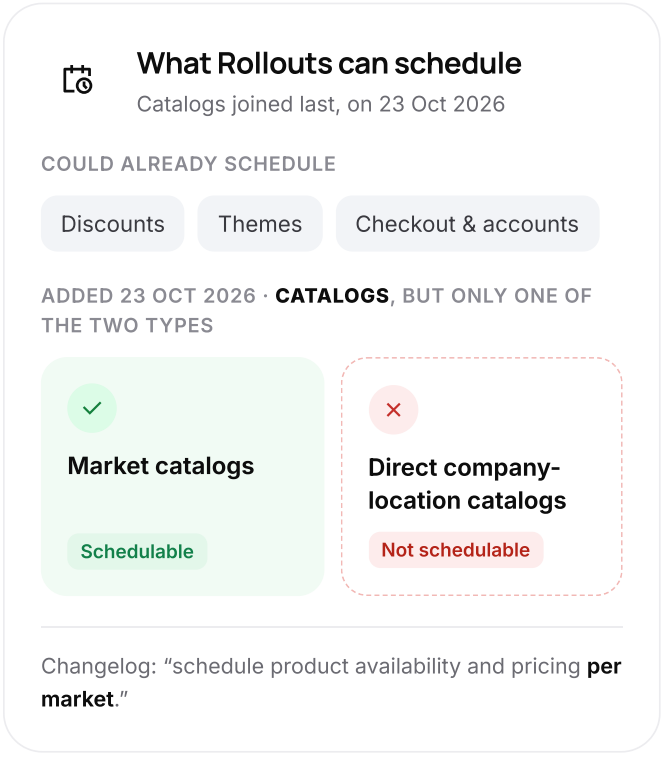
```
# every B2B plan · schedulable
type MarketCatalog {
  ± markets
  ± marketsCount
    id: ID!
    operations: [ResourceOperation!]!
    priceList: PriceList
    publication: Publication
    status: CatalogStatus! # shared
    title: String!
```

A correction worth stating plainly

I read `status` as "the field a rollout flips." Wrong: `RolloutCatalogActivateChange` activates a catalog for a treatment's buyers *"without changing the catalog's native status."* A rollout overlays an activation for part of the audience. I had the evidence in hand and read it backwards.

```
}
```

```
# returned by RolloutTreatment.changes,
read side
type RolloutCatalogActivateChange {
    catalog: Catalog # the interface, not
    MarketCatalog
    id: ID!
}
```



Second, the finding I'd lead with in a review. Rollouts carry changes as `treatments`; a catalog change inside one is `RolloutCatalogActivateChange`, and its `catalog` field is typed as the `Catalog` interface, not `MarketCatalog`.

Read carefully, that's weaker evidence than it looks. It's a **read-side** field: how Shopify models a rollout change when reading one back. It says nothing about whether create and update mutations accept a `CompanyLocationCatalog`, or whether validation, audience targeting and permissions would allow it. It suggests the two types aren't alien to each other, a reason to ask an engineer, not an answer.

The public schema suggests a common read-side model. It does not prove rollout mutations accept every catalog type.

Verify: Catalog · CompanyLocationCatalog · MarketCatalog · RolloutCatalogActivateChange · Rollout · changelog. **What I still can't claim:** that the shared interface makes direct catalogs valid rollout targets. Engineering must validate the write path and runtime behavior before any estimate.

Four explanations, and I'm not picking one

I can see the asymmetry. I can't see the reasoning behind it. The absence of a public explanation is not the presence of a mistake. Each of these fits every fact I have.

Explanation 1

Deliberate differentiation

Scheduling belongs to the market model because markets are the rule-based layer, and overrides are meant to be deliberate manual acts.

Would confirm it: A design document saying so, or anyone on the team articulating it.

Explanation 2

A simpler workflow, on purpose

Direct assignment is the quick path for a customer-specific override, and keeping it free of rollout machinery is what keeps it quick.

Would confirm it: Merchants describing it that way in interviews, and choosing it for that reason.

Explanation 3 — The one I want true

An increment, not an endpoint

Catalog scheduling launched with market-based eligibility. Direct catalogs may simply not have been in the first scope, a shipping order rather than a verdict.

Would confirm it: Roadmap intent, or the absence of any decision record on the boundary.

Explanation 4

A constraint I can't see

Audience resolution and pricing precedence may make scheduled activation genuinely hard for a catalog bound to a location rather than a market.

Would confirm it: An engineer explaining why. The most interesting one, and the one I'm least able to test.

All four are live. I notice I *want* explanation 3 to be true, because it's the one where my finding is most useful, a good reason to be suspicious of my own reading. Investigation 1 distinguishes between them, and it costs one conversation.

What I can say without knowing which

Shopify documents the distinction and explains when each assignment route is appropriate. However, the plan comparison does not surface the Rollouts limitation alongside the Plus-only direct-assignment capability. Whether merchants connect these details before choosing a route, particularly in the actual setup flow, remains unvalidated.

A useful improvement may be one decision aid at setup: audience scope, precedence, scheduling eligibility and the 25-catalog-per-location limit, together. A product-content hypothesis, not a proven usability failure, test comprehension first.

Why the framing matters more than the finding

A proposal to *"un-gate direct catalogs for Advanced merchants"* would argue against a plan boundary Shopify published in April, so I don't make it.

What I'm bringing instead is a question: **do merchants connect the scheduling and precedence trade-off before they choose a route?** That's testable, and the answer may be that no engineering is needed.

06 · Four outcomes

Four ways this could end, including doing nothing.

My instinct was to compare three build options and recommend one. That chooses a solution before establishing the problem is worth solving. Do nothing is first deliberately: on current evidence it's the one I can least rule out.

Outcome A

Do nothing

The market-per-location workaround is adequate. Merchants don't reprice on a calendar, or already handle it through their ERP and the API.

Cost $$$$ None

Would have to be true: Investigations 3 and 5 come back small: few use direct assignment, they reprice rarely, or integrations cover it.

Outcome B — Working preference

Fix the disclosure

Shopify already explains when each route fits. Surface the Rollouts limitation next to the Plus-only direct-assignment capability, on the plan comparison and in setup. No engineering.

Cost $$$$ Very low

Would have to be true: Comprehension testing shows merchants don't connect the Rollouts limitation with the Plus-only capability before choosing a route. Test the current journey first.

Outcome C

Bring direct catalogs to parity

Investigate making direct company-location catalogs valid Rollout targets, preserving precedence and defining safe activation and recovery.

Cost ???? Unknown

Would have to be true: Investigation 4 shows merchants choose direct assignment for its precedence and still need scheduled repricing, and 4 and 5 show the market route costs them something real. None of that is established.

Outcome D

Converge the setup decision

Create one guided assignment experience that helps merchants choose between market and direct assignment based on audience scope, pricing precedence and scheduling needs, while preserving the underlying distinction between the two models.

Cost ???? Unscoped

Would have to be true: Interviews show merchants pick a route without weighing scope, precedence and scheduling, and the outcome B content fix, tested, doesn't close that gap. Not a merger of the two data models.

Option C is the one I wanted to be right, and I had it written up as obvious before I'd earned it. **My working preference is B over C, but I don't have enough evidence to rank the outcomes by likelihood.** A remains viable until investigations 3 and 4 are complete. Cost for C: the schema exposes a shared read-side interface, but nothing about mutation eligibility, validation, targeting, permissions or feasibility.

What outcome D means, and doesn't

D is a guided setup decision, not a merged data model. Market and direct assignment keep their different precedence rules underneath; the merchant gets one place that asks about audience scope, pricing precedence and scheduling needs, and recommends a route.

The evidence that would justify D over B or A

A content fix (B) is cheaper, so D needs more: interviews that show merchants choose a route without weighing those three factors, and a tested B that still leaves them choosing wrongly. If merchants already choose well, or B fixes it, D isn't justified, and if nobody is hurt by the choice, A is the answer.

A negotiated price is a contractual commitment. Every buyer purchasing for the same company location must receive the intended contract price, so even Launch and Event use 100% of the eligible audience. That's a proposed requirement, not an existing direct-catalog Rollouts capability.

One thing I'd cut from my own proposal

The original idea extended all three rollout types to direct catalogs: Launch, Event and Experiment. **Experiment stays out of scope.**

Rollout traffic allocation is a percentage of eligible visitors, assigned at random; Experiment adds a control/treatment split. That's not the same as assigning one negotiated price to every buyer at a company location. I haven't tested whether Shopify would expose inconsistent contract prices, so I won't claim it, the initial design assumes 100% allocation to the eligible company-location audience.

What I'd want an engineer to tell me

Option C rests on a claim I can only half-support: the schema types `RolloutCatalogActivateChange.catalog` as the `Catalog` interface, which `CompanyLocationCatalog` implements. That tells me the *returned* type. It does **not** tell me that create and update mutations accept it, that validation permits it, that targeting can serve a company-location catalog to a treatment's audience, or that permissions and billing agree. A reviewer was right to push me on this. The defensible sentence: **the schema suggests a common abstraction; engineering validation is required.** That's one conversation, inside investigation 5.



If price experimentation is ever considered, the randomization and analysis unit must be chosen deliberately, potentially the company location or merchant. Launch and Event are the only candidates for discovery, and even they need engineering validation of activation and rollback semantics.

07 · What's next

What I'd need to prove before anyone writes code.

I had a revenue number, $180 to $270 million, and every input underneath it was invented. I don't know how many merchants use direct catalogs, how often they reprice, or what it costs them when it goes wrong. Those aren't gaps to paper over. Closing them would be the first three weeks of the job.

Five proposed investigations, in dependency order

My instinct was to order these by cost. That's wrong: establish the intended behavior first, reproduce it, *then* quantify who it affects. Sizing a problem before you understand the decision that created it is how you end up measuring the wrong thing precisely.

Four of the five have a result that would stop the work. The second doesn't: reproducing the behavior in a test store proves how the product works, not whether the workaround is good enough for merchants. That decision waits for the interviews.

How this differs from section 08: these five establish what must be learned and what each answer rules out. Section 08 assumes the answers came back favorably. If you only read one, read this, 08 is contingency planning for an outcome I'm not predicting.

Discovery, in dependency order — 3 Weeks

Proposed, given access. Nothing here has started.

WEEK 1 Cheap checks first, one after another

1. **Original rationale** — A day
   Stop if a current rationale already covers the asymmetry
2. **Reproduce behavior** — An afternoon
   Never a stop on its own: it proves technical behavior, not merchant need
3. **Quantify usage** — A query
   Stop if the direct-assignment cohort is thin

WEEKS 1–3 In parallel

4. **Interview 8–10 merchants** — Two weeks
   Stop if the workaround meets a verified merchant need
5. **Operational impact** — Two weeks
   Stop if repricing is rare or already automated

Only the rationale check can stop the work inside week one. The customer-need decision waits for the interviews.

What the three weeks assume

These are proposed investigations, not work I've done. As an independent author I haven't had access to Shopify's internal data or teams. The three-week estimate depends on access to:

- Internal product rationale and the relevant product owners
- A Shopify test store
- Usage data or internal queries
- Merchant recruitment and interview availability

Where each answer leads **Only C needs engineering**

4 of 5 checks can stop the work

Five checks run left to right. A stop result exits down to an outcome; investigation 2 informs the interviews instead of stopping anything. Only passing all five reaches a build.

1 **Original rationale**
Stops if a current rationale already covers the asymmetry
B Fix the disclosure · A Do nothing

2 **Reproduce behavior**
Never stops it alone: proves behavior, not merchant need
→ Informs 4

3 **Quantify usage**
Stops if the direct-assignment cohort is thin
A Do nothing

4 **Interview merchants**
Stops if the workaround meets a verified merchant need
A Do nothing · B Fix the disclosure · D Guided setup

5 **Operational impact**
Stops if repricing is rare or already automated
A Do nothing

✓ **All five pass**
No stop result fires
C Parity build

Where a stop result leads: A Do nothing · B Fix the disclosure · D Guided setup → Informs a later check

C Parity build, only if all five pass

#	Question it answers	Evidence required	Stops the work if...	Leads to	Uncertainty that remains
1	**Shopify's original rationale.** What was the intended division of labor between market and direct assignment, and why were direct catalogs left out of Rollouts?	Product and design documentation; one conversation with the owners of B2B catalogs	A current, deliberate rationale already accounts for the asymmetry.	B if merchants still need the trade-off surfaced; otherwise A	Whether that rationale still matches how merchants use the two routes

#	Question it answers	Evidence required	Stops the work if...	Leads to	Uncertainty that remains
2	**Reproduce the behavior.** Does the storefront resolve prices as documented for a single-location market, a broader company-location market and a region market?	A test store with overlapping products, quantity rules and volume pricing; the buyer-facing resolved price compared with the documented hierarchy	Nothing, on its own. It proves technical behavior, not that the workaround is adequate for merchants. A mismatch goes to engineering as a behavior question.	Informs investigation 4	Whether merchants experience the documented behavior as workable
3	**Quantify usage.** How many Plus merchants use direct assignment *versus* single-location markets, and with how many catalogs?	Two internal queries: direct-assignment usage and catalog-count distribution; Plus shops already using location-scoped markets	The direct-assignment cohort is thin, or most hold one or two catalogs.	A	Why merchants chose their route; counts don't say
4	**Interview merchants.** Why did they choose their route, and does the market workaround meet their real repricing need?	8–10 interviews about past behavior, across the four groups below	The workaround meets a verified merchant need.	A if the need is met; B if merchants don't connect the details; D if they choose without weighing scope, precedence and scheduling, and B doesn't fix it	A discovery sample, not a representative one; patterns need checking against usage data
5	**Operational impact.** How often do negotiated prices change, what breaks, and what already covers it?	Repricing frequency, integration dependencies, manual-work estimates; engineering's read on what parity would cost	Repricing is rare, or integrations already automate it.	A. C only if all five pass	Cost depends on engineering validating the write path

Investigation 3's second query is the one I'd fight for. Counting direct-assignment users gives the cohort size; counting Plus merchants already using single-location markets gives the baseline. Together with the interviews, they show whether merchants choose direct assignment because they need its precedence, or because it's the more intuitive way to make a customer price list. The first points toward parity; the second toward guidance.

A constraint I discovered late

Shopify states a rollout *"can include more than one catalog change"*, bulk scheduling already exists for market catalogs. But a catalog can only be in one unended rollout at a time, which shapes how a merchant with overlapping seasonal changes would use this. I'd been assuming unlimited composability.

How I'd run investigation 4

The failure mode in discovery is asking people whether they want a feature. They always say yes. So the script is about the last time, not the next time, and never about whether they'd like something I've proposed.

Q4 is the one I most want answered: how they chose between direct and market assignment, and what else they considered. I don't mention a single-location market until Q7, after I understand their workflow, so the alternative doesn't steer their answers. If most hadn't considered it, that points at guidance rather than capability.

Interview guide

45 min

8–10 Plus B2B merchants · feeds investigation 4

Q1	How many company locations and distinct catalogs do you manage?
Q2	Walk me through the last time you changed negotiated prices for a company location.
Q3	How did you prepare the new prices and make them live at the intended time?
Q4	THE ONE THAT DECIDES IT **How did you decide between direct assignment and market assignment? What alternatives did you consider?**
Q5	Show me your current catalog configuration. When overlapping products exist, how do you know which price the buyer receives?
Q6	What happened the last time a pricing update failed or went wrong? How did you recover?
Q7	Had you previously considered or used a B2B market targeting one specific company location? (Only introduced after understanding their existing workflow.)

Every question is about the last time something happened, not what they'd want next time.

Who I'd recruit, and why each group

8–10 interviews is a proposed discovery sample to find patterns and surprises, not a representative sample.

Direct-assignment users

Did they choose it for its precedence, and how do they reprice today?

Single-location-market users

Does the workaround already meet the need, and what does it cost them?

Merchants using both

Where do precedence and scheduling collide in a real configuration?

Integration or ERP users, where relevant

Does scheduling already live outside Shopify, and at what upkeep?

The model I'd fill in, rather than the number I'd guess

The first decision is whether there's a real workflow problem. Only then would I estimate engineering cost against measured operational impact. Plus list price is not incremental revenue at risk, and broad wholesale-efficiency case studies are not evidence this feature improves retention.

Retention or expansion impact needs a separate cohort analysis, not interviews alone. I wouldn't forecast revenue or retention from forum posts. The decision I'd bring to prioritization is a bounded discovery question, how many Plus merchants use direct assignment, what work it creates, and whether the precedence guarantee matters enough that a scheduled market isn't a substitute. If the cohort is small or the market route already serves the workflow, the proposal should stop.

Investigation 3

Cohort sizes

Direct-assignment vs single-location-market users

Investigation 3

Catalogs & locations per merchant

Does maintenance plausibly create scale work?

Investigations 4 + 5

Repricing frequency & recovery cost

How much operational burden exists today

Investigations 3 + 4

Why direct assignment

Functionally necessary, or a default-choice issue?

08 · If the answer is build

How it would ship, contingency, not a roadmap.

Shopify ships with gradual rollouts, developer previews, Merchant Success beta cohorts, and twice-yearly Editions. A plan that ignores that machinery isn't a plan.

This section is conditional, and I nearly deleted it

Everything below assumes outcome C, and only applies if the five investigations support a build. **My working preference is B over C, but I don't have enough evidence to rank the outcomes by likelihood.** The initial recommendation stays: no build until evidence supports it. I've kept this because "I'd find out first" is only credible if you can show you'd know what to do with a yes.

The first evaluation is workflow feasibility and operational impact, not GMV. Adoption and time saved can be measured in a beta; any causal claim about support load or retention needs an adequately powered merchant-level evaluation. **Scope:** Launch and Event only; Experiment excluded until engineering verifies the allocation unit. **Existing capability:** a rollout can already include several catalog changes, the question is whether direct catalogs can be valid targets and what precedence-safe behavior requires.

A concrete workflow to validate before designing UI

1 Select

Pick the direct-assigned catalogs and company locations in the change.

Safeguard: Show unique catalogs and locations separately; never infer one catalog per account.

2 Prepare

Prepare a new direct catalog with the revised prices; never edit the active catalog in place for a future change.

Safeguard: Show current vs proposed catalog and variant differences; confirm publication and quantity/volume rules.

3 Resolve

Where precedence bites

Preview the buyer price for each affected location and overlapping product, including the catalog being replaced.

Safeguard: Explain the precedence chain and flag any catalog that would keep winning, including an old direct catalog with a lower price.

4 Schedule

Launch or Event, start/end, store timezone, 100% of the location's eligible buyers, a proposed requirement.

Safeguard: No random partial allocation for contract prices. Validate targeting, eligibility, the 25-per-location limit and one-unended-rollout rule.

5 Confirm

Review a final summary before scheduling.

Safeguard: Every location, catalog, overlap, effective price and blocked item. No silent partial success.

6 Monitor

Review the activation outcome and resolve failures.

Safeguard: Engineering validates what partial failure, recovery and audit would require; I'm not assuming atomic activation or rollback exists. A revert changes activation, not prior prices.

What happens to the catalog it replaces

The flow prepares a new direct catalog, but a new catalog going live doesn't, by itself, retire the old one. Where the public documentation doesn't establish the behavior, it's an engineering validation question, not a feature I'm assuming.

The old direct catalog

Does it have to be drafted or deactivated for the new one to take effect? The public documentation doesn't say that activating a new catalog replaces the old one.

Both active at once

Shopify documents that when several direct catalogs on one company location include the same product, the lowest price applies. If the old catalog stays active and is cheaper, the buyer keeps the old price.

One scheduled change

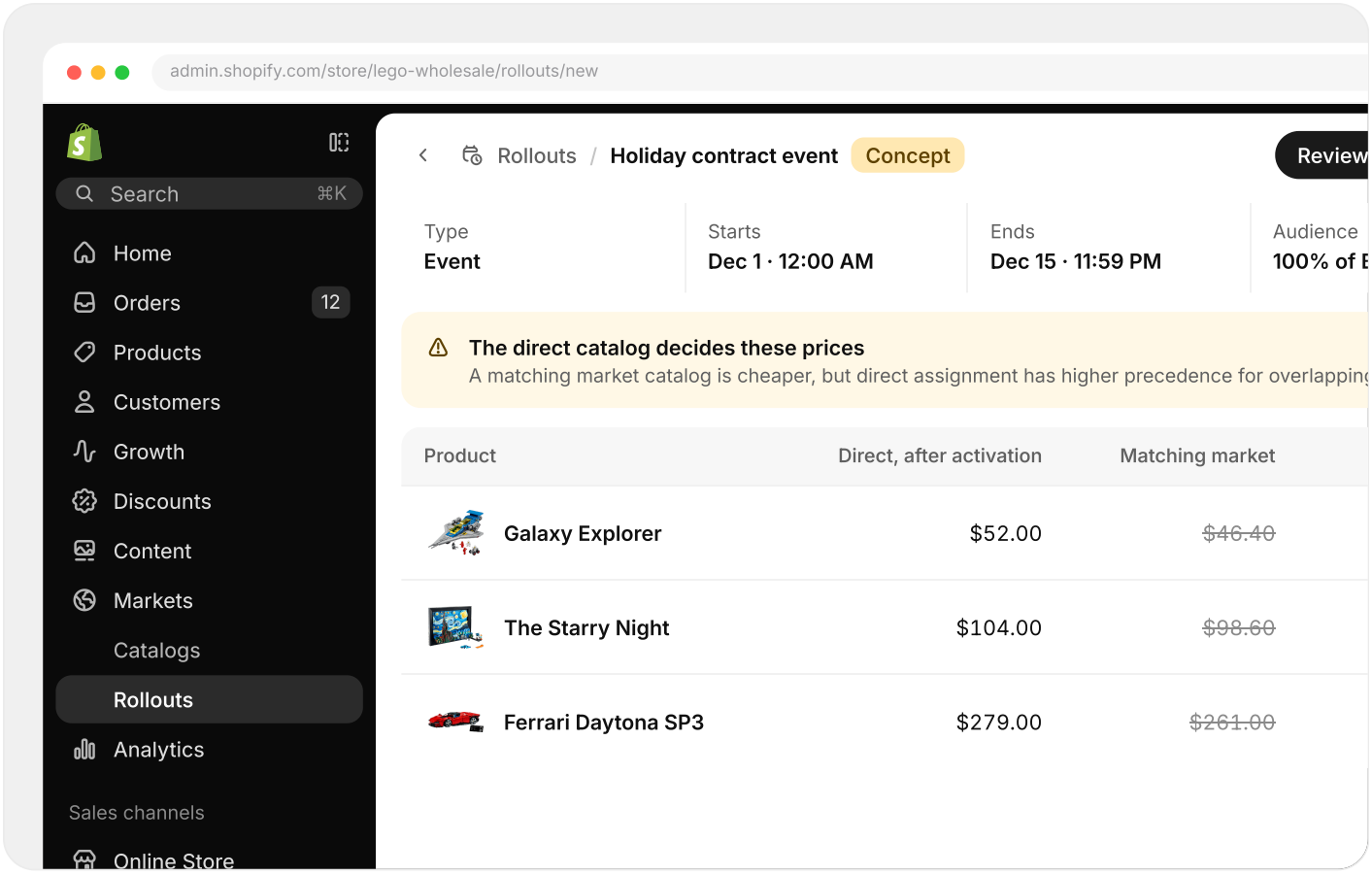
Today a rollout can include more than one catalog change for market catalogs. Whether drafting the old direct catalog and activating the new one could be scheduled together is an engineering validation question.

Partial failure

If one activation succeeds and the other fails, what does the buyer see, and how does the merchant find out? Validation question. I'm not assuming an atomic transaction or rollback.

Recovery and audit

Start from what existing activity logs, API records and webhooks already record, before proposing anything new.



Concept, not an existing Shopify screen. Step 3, resolve, drawn with LEGO as a hypothetical merchant (LEGO isn't on Shopify): real set names and images, invented retailer and contract prices. It assumes a proposed company-location audience and 100% allocation; today's Rollouts audience is market-derived. The required decision is to show the buyer's resolved price, not just the catalog being scheduled.
Open questions: a direct-catalog target extension or a new orchestration layer; whether catalog versions are needed; how conflicts with market catalogs surface; what existing activity logs, API records and webhooks already provide before proposing an audit trail.

Only if the investigations say build

22+ weeks

Conditional on outcome C. Each phase is a gate, not a commitment.

QUARTER 1

1 **Discovery** — Weeks 1–3

Gate: if usage comes back thin, write it up and stop

2 **Design and scope** — Weeks 4–7

Gate: can a rollout target a non-market catalog, and at what cost?

3 **Closed beta** — Weeks 8–13

Gate: a provisional 25–40 merchant learning cohort, Launch first

QUARTER 2

4 **Open beta** — Weeks 14–21

Gate: Event only once Launch and rollback are proven

5 **GA and disclosure** — Weeks 22+

Gate: opt-in first, Editions after adoption evidence

Weeks 1–3 · Discovery

Answer the five investigations. Earn the right to build.

Queries and conversations from section 07; 8–10 merchants across direct, single-location-market and mixed setups, about what they did last January. Walk into the B2B and Markets teams and ask what I'm missing.

Weeks 4–7 · Design & scope

Find out what the object model will allow

With Markets engineering: can a rollout target a non-market catalog, at what cost? Design against a real account list, not a mock with six rows. Audit existing history, API records and webhooks first.

Weeks 8–13 · Closed beta

25–40 Plus merchants, a provisional size

A learning cohort, not a statistical sample. Selected through Merchant Success from discovery participants and other direct-assignment merchants who reprice on a schedule, mixing catalog counts and integration setups. It validates the workflow, the resolved-price preview and failure handling, not market-wide demand. Launch activation first.

Weeks 14–21 · Open beta

Comparison design only if the cohort supports it

Event only once Launch is reliable. No 5% holdout by intuition: estimate population, baseline, minimum detectable effect and sample size first, or report descriptively.

Weeks 22+ · GA & disclosure

Ship it, and surface the trade-off

Opt-in for eligible Plus merchants first, keeping direct assignment Plus-only. GA and an Editions announcement follow evidence. Plan comparison and setup show precedence and scheduling eligibility together.

What I'd measure, and in what order

Stage · metric	What's measured	Eligible cohort	Observation window	How it's collected	Decision it informs
Beta **Workflow completion and preparation time**	Share of scheduled direct-catalog changes completed without help; time from starting a change to scheduling it	Beta merchants	Every change they schedule during the beta	Product instrumentation, against each merchant's own baseline from discovery	Whether the workflow is usable enough to widen the beta
Beta **Unique catalogs and company locations per rollout**	Distinct catalogs and locations in each scheduled change; one account ≠ one catalog	Beta merchants	During the beta	Rollout records	Whether merchants coordinate multi-catalog changes, and so whether bulk handling matters
Open beta **Adoption among eligible merchants**	Share of eligible merchants who schedule at least one change	Plus merchants using direct assignment	At least one full repricing cycle, set from discovery; contract pricing may be annual or seasonal, so not a fixed 90 days	Usage data	Whether the need is real at scale. Low adoption over a full cycle means I was wrong, and I'd say so
Open beta **Activation failures, precedence conflicts, incorrect buyer prices**	Failed activations, conflicts flagged at preview, orders at an unintended price	Every scheduled change	Continuous	Activation logs, preview results, resolved-price checks against the intended price	Guardrail: pause the beta if it rises. A revert changes activation, not prices
Later, if a baseline exists **Support contacts about catalog updates**	Contact volume and themes	Eligible merchants	Comparable periods before and after	Support tagging	Descriptive only, unless the baseline and sample support more

Stage · metric	What's measured	Eligible cohort	Observation window	How it's collected	Decision it informs
Later, if powered **Retention or expansion**	Merchant-level retention or plan expansion	A defined cohort and assignment unit	Long enough to cover renewals	Cohort analysis with an adequately powered evaluation	Not a promised outcome; causal claims only if the design supports them

The initial success criterion is reliable workflow completion and reduced preparation effort. Discovery findings set the observation windows. GMV and retention are downstream hypotheses, not promised outcomes.

09 · Commitments

What I'd commit to, and what I wouldn't.

The tempting promise is feature outcomes, scheduling that works, bulk operations, an audit trail. I can't promise those; I haven't established the feature should be built. What I can commit to is the investigation and its honesty.

I'd commit to

A decision in about three weeks, given access

Five investigations in dependency order. The first, Shopify's original rationale, takes a day and could stop the work early.

Understanding the original decision before changing it

Investigation 1 is reading why Shopify built both. If a current rationale accounts for the asymmetry, that's the answer.

Testing the disclosure regardless of the outcome

Shopify documents the distinction. What's unvalidated is whether merchants connect the Rollouts limitation with the Plus-only capability before choosing; I'd test that whatever else comes back.

Killing this publicly if the answers come back small

Each investigation has a stated stop result. I've already killed my own thesis once; doing it twice costs nothing.

I wouldn't promise

That this is worth building

I can't rule out that the market workaround is adequate and nothing needs to change beyond the docs.

A cost estimate for parity

The schema hints the model allows it, nothing about mutations, validation, targeting, permissions or billing.

Revenue impact

I had a $180–270M estimate and deleted it. I'm not replacing it with a better-dressed guess.

That merchants want this

Six mixed-provenance signals point at adjacent workflows. None validates direct-assignment demand.

This section changed more than any other. It used to be product guarantees. Now I know what to find out, not what to build.

Appendix

The working, for anyone who wants to go deeper.

The main argument ends with the commitments above. What follows is supporting material: the objections I used to pressure-test the recommendation, and the full discovery log, including where I was wrong. Full source exhibits sit in the sections they support, behind “Show” toggles, and every source is listed at the foot of the page.

A · Questions I used to pressure-test it
B · The discovery log
Sources

Appendix A · Q&A

Questions I used to pressure-test the recommendation

These are hypothetical review objections I wrote to challenge my own proposal, from the point of view of each function. They were not asked by Shopify employees.



Hypothetical · Product lens

A B2B market can target one company location. So your gap doesn't exist. Why are we still talking?

You're right, and that question killed the proposal I had built. A Plus merchant can schedule location-specific pricing by creating a market for one named company location, provided no higher-precedence direct catalog keeps determining the price for overlapping products. Section 03 is built around that finding rather than hiding it.

What I'd put in front of you is narrower. The precedence rules are clear in the developer guide. The question isn't whether the hierarchy is documented; it's whether merchants understand it and need both precedence and scheduling for the same contract. Investigation 2 checks the live behavior; investigation 4 asks the merchants.

Hypothetical · Product lens

Would extending scheduled activation to directly assigned catalogs change the role of direct assignment as a Shopify Plus differentiator?

Possibly, and I can't answer it from outside. Direct assignment is a published Plus capability, and scheduling it could make it more valuable, or change how it's positioned against what every B2B plan gets through markets.

So the proposal keeps the boundary: direct assignment stays Plus-only, and any scheduling for it would be Plus-only too. What that does to Plus positioning is a question to validate with the people who own the plan structure, not a conclusion I'd draw. It's one more reason the recommendation is no build until the evidence supports one.

Hypothetical · Engineering lens

You built a confident proposal on a GraphQL interface type. That's not how our system works.

Fair, and I've narrowed the claim. The schema shows `RolloutCatalogActivateChange.catalog` returns the `Catalog` interface, which `CompanyLocationCatalog` implements. It does *not* show that mutations accept it, that validation permits it, that targeting can serve it to a treatment's audience, or that permissions and billing agree.

The defensible sentence: the public schema suggests a common catalog abstraction, but doesn't establish that direct company-location catalogs are supported by rollout mutations. Engineering validation is required. I'd previously written something much more confident.

I also got a related thing backwards: I claimed `status` was the field a rollout flips. Your docs say a rollout activates a catalog *"without changing the catalog's native status."* It's corrected in section 05 rather than deleted.

Hypothetical · Engineering lens

Merchants at that scale use the API. Why would they care about admin scheduling?

Some will, and I've written that as a kill criterion in investigation 5 rather than an objection to argue past. If repricing is already automated through ERP integrations, this is a quality-of-life fix and should be prioritized as one.

Two things make me check rather than assume. An ERP or app workaround may need its own scheduler, versioning, recovery logic and audit trail for a workflow Rollouts already provides for market catalogs. And it's only available to merchants with engineering capacity, but that's a hypothesis; I have no data on what share of Plus B2B merchants have developers.

Hypothetical · Engineering lens

What if the engineering cost is much higher than you think?

Entirely possible, and I've deliberately not estimated it because I can't see the code. Rollouts may be coupled to the market object in ways that make this a rewrite rather than an extension.

That's why weeks 4–7 are a scoping gate rather than a design phase. If the coupling is deep, the proposal changes shape, most likely to a narrower "scheduled activation on a direct catalog" that borrows the idea without inheriting the whole Rollouts surface.

Hypothetical · Support lens

Why hasn't this come up from merchants, if it's real?

Section 04 has six public signals, verbatim and linked, with what each does and doesn't demonstrate. None establishes that direct assignment caused the reported problems. No one in the sample asks for Rollouts on direct catalogs, and I can't turn that absence into proof of latent demand.

The signals are heterogeneous, workload, webhooks, bulk-edit recovery, a developer's validation. They don't establish a common failure. I can't rebut that from public data; the defensible next step is targeted merchant research, which is why investigation 4 is interviews rather than ticket analysis.

Hypothetical · Research lens

Your merchant evidence is forum posts. We have actual research. Why would I value yours?

You shouldn't value it above your own. You have the data I spent a week approximating badly; if your research contradicts mine, yours wins. You can query how many Plus merchants use direct catalogs and how often they reprice. I can't.

What public evidence gets you is limited but checkable: every quote has a link, and each signal is labeled for what it does and doesn't demonstrate.

Appendix B · The journey

How I got here, including the parts I got wrong.

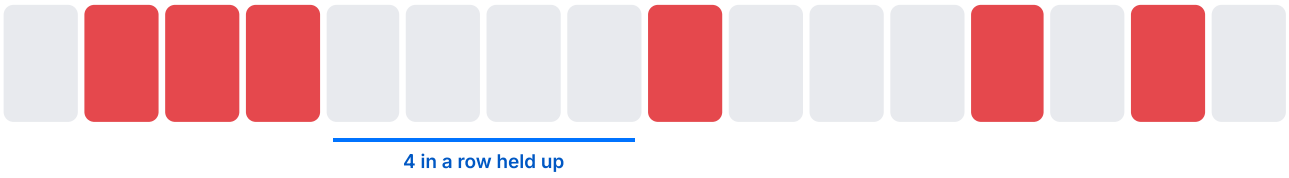
The finished argument makes the process look cleaner than it was. Three of my first four ideas were wrong, two of them in ways that would have embarrassed me in an interview.

Every idea I logged, in order

One square per idea. Pick one to read it on its own.

6 of 16 turned out wrong

10 held up



An idea that turned out wrong An idea that held up

Starting context · secondary source

+140%
Shopify B2B GMV growth, 2024

+96%
Shopify B2B GMV growth, 2025

Uncap, *Shopify Statistics 2026*. A reason to look, never evidence this gap matters.

01 **Started from the earnings call, not the product**

A secondary industry summary reported B2B GMV growth of 96% in 2025 after 140% in 2024. I treated that as context for asking which workflows might be under-served, not as evidence of demand.

02 ~~"Per-customer pricing is locked behind a $2,300 plan"~~ Wrong

I'd read it in four agency blogs and believed it. Custom B2B pricing works on Basic; what's Plus-only is direct assignment. I only caught it reading the plan page to get a number right.

03 ~~"10 customers per company location"~~ Wrong

Also from a blog. The real numbers are 50 customers and 25 catalogs. Two wrong facts in one afternoon convinced me to rebuild everything off primary documentation only.

04 ~~"So un-gate direct assignment for Advanced"~~ Killed

My first real proposal. I killed it after re-reading the April announcement, Shopify had just published that boundary deliberately. Asking them to reverse it is a misread of the business.

05 **Found the rollout sentence while checking something else** Kept

Verifying assignment limits, I read past the section I needed. One sentence in a paragraph about something else. I almost scrolled past it.

06 **Reframed from "give it away" to "it's incomplete"** The turn

One question asks Shopify to reverse a plan boundary; the other asks whether the documented distinction creates a workflow problem worth solving. The second is more precise and doesn't presume the answer.

07 **Deleted my own revenue estimate** Hardest edit

$180–270M looked impressive. Every input was invented. Taking it out made the document weaker to skim and much stronger to interrogate.

08 **Had the draft torn apart, and the worst note was right** Kept the note

A hostile reviewer: the whole thing was Help Center pages and two merchants Shopify published itself. No merchant had chosen to speak. A document about a problem, written without the people who have it.

09 ~~Went looking for merchants and nearly concluded I was wrong~~ Almost killed it

Forums, the request board, YouTube, Reddit, X, LinkedIn. No explicit request for a rollout on a company-location catalog. The honest conclusion might have been a real gap nobody cares about.

10 **Then noticed I'd been searching for the wrong sentence** The second turn

The public record surfaced adjacent symptoms, manual edits, bulk-operation risk, automation requests, rollback tooling, but not one shared failure. I keep that distinction visible.

11 **Stopped guessing about architecture and read the schema** Should have come first

Twenty minutes in the reference docs: `RolloutCatalogActivateChange.catalog` is typed as the `Catalog` interface, not `MarketCatalog`, the opposite of what I'd argued. A plausible paragraph instead of a link is a worse habit than being wrong.

12 **Checked the changelog date, then my own conclusion** Changed the pitch

Catalog rollouts shipped 23 October 2026, shortly before. The changelog shows the scope, not why direct catalogs were excluded or whether that's permanent. The timing is a moment to ask, not evidence of intent.

13 ~~Found the paragraph that killed my proposal~~ Thesis dead

A reviewer asked whether a market could target one location. I'd assumed not. Shopify's own worked example: *"Company Location A, a market specifically for a single company location."* Documented the

whole time.

14 **Read the precedence rule properly and found the better finding** The real one

Direct assignment takes precedence over market catalogs. The override layer can't be scheduled; location-specific market pricing can. The surviving question: does anyone need both?

15 ~~**Invented a documentation contradiction that wasn't there**~~ Caught in review

I treated two precedence rules as ambiguous, then found the developer docs' full hierarchy. The ordering is documented. The open question is whether merchants understand and need it.

16 **Reordered my discovery plan after one sentence of feedback** Best note I got

My plan started with sizing. Someone pointed out I was sizing a problem before understanding the decision that created it: *before proposing another way to manage B2B pricing, understand why Shopify already built two.*



Who wrote this?

I'm Praharsha Nelaturi, an M.S. Software Engineering candidate at UC Irvine (expected December 2026), and a Product Manager with 3+ years of experience across 0-to-1 B2B products, most recently at Superloopz, an AI-native commerce platform.

LinkedIn | Portfolio | Quick connect | Mail me

If any claim here is wrong, I'd genuinely like to know.

Praharsha Nelaturi · Product case study, November 2026. Written from public sources. I have no affiliation with Shopify and no access to their internal data, which is why section 07 is five investigations rather than a proposal, and why section 03 documents the finding that invalidated my thesis. The correction log in section 01 exists because two claims already were wrong.

Shopify documentation

B2B features by plan: the plan matrix, 3-assignment cap, direct catalogs as Plus-only

B2B catalogs with Markets: **the rollout constraint**, precedence rules, 25-catalog location limit

Catalogs and pricing in B2B: the rollout constraint, stated a second time

Customizing B2B pricing using catalogs: third statement; 10,000 catalogs per store

Creating and managing companies: 50 customers and 25 catalogs per location

Understanding market types: B2B markets targeting specific company locations

Types of rollouts and changes: Launch, Event, Experiment, catalog activation

Requirements and considerations for Rollouts: one unended rollout per catalog, market-derived audience, visitor allocation

Creating a rollout: multiple catalog changes, scheduled start/end

Overview of B2B features · Overview of markets features

Shopify, on the record & schema

Pricing page: Plus "Starts at $2,300 USD/mo"; **per-term prices not published**

B2B for all, 2 Apr 2026, the plan boundary, DAX and Snyder evidence

Snyder Performance Engineering: 25% back-office reduction, 40% spend increase

LEGO: set names, numbers, images and retail prices used in the illustrative admin screens. LEGO is a hypothetical merchant here; it is not a Shopify customer

Jay's Brick Blog: LEGO 10497 Galaxy Explorer announcement (US$99.99)

Q3 2026 results: $119.1B GMV, segment context

Catalog, CompanyLocationCatalog, MarketCatalog: the one-field difference

RolloutCatalogActivateChange: **catalog: Catalog**, the interface · Rollout

About catalogs in Markets: pricing-priority hierarchy, two-catalog pattern

Changelog, 23 Oct 2026, *"per market"* · Rollouts queries and webhooks

Merchants in public, context, rejected

EVP, 17 Dec 2024, four catalogs, **zero replies**

lu_judy, 24 Jul 2026, webhook / Flow trigger request

Bryce_David, 1 Aug 2026, 109 reviews; plus Ian_Chechin and zhouhua1998071

UndoB2B, 12 Sep 2026, developer validating a $39/month price-restore app

ONHOW Studio, 12 Apr 2026, both methods; scheduling never appears

Secondary, context only: Uncap B2B GMV growth; trade.gov $36T B2B ecommerce; Store Leads ~2.82M stores (third-party crawl); a ~12% B2B-share estimate with no published method; Shopify 10-K "millions of merchants"; agentic commerce and UCP docs, connection to B2B unverified

Checked and rejected: per-customer pricing as Plus-only; a 10-customer location limit; **the "50 markets per store" limit**, not on any Shopify page, not used anywhere here

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Independent case study by Praharsha Nelaturi. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Shopify. · pnelatur@uci.edu

Not affiliated with or endorsed by the LEGO Group. Shopify and LEGO are trademarks of their owners. LEGO appears as a hypothetical merchant for recognizability; it is not a Shopify customer. Admin screens are recreations of the 2026 Shopify admin; the retailer, catalogs, contract prices and screen states are invented. Pricing and Help Center images are real screenshots of shopify.com. Charts use BeUI and BoardUI; product scenes use the Stageshow kit; layout follows the Flowpath template. Avatars are illustrative DiceBear "Notionists" (CC0), not likenesses of the people quoted.